

8.1 Buying

8.1.1 Product Reviews

Sites with tech-product reviews have been covered in the previous chapter. It is worth noting that the information on these sites has a one-dimensional, one-directional aspect to it. The site is generally supplied with the products to be tested and their reviews are based on the performance of the product during a brief testing period. The single dimension here is performance. The long term user, which is what most buyers are, is not represented in the whole process.

Additionally, the flow of information is unidirectional, since the user can only passively read the information without being able to ask questions. Nonetheless, these sites are great places to find comparative information across brands of the same product type.

Only a long term user can describe absolute usage experience of the product. For a valid and healthy discussion, one needs to look at forums. To find usage reviews, head to one of the following sites:

Mouthshut.com

Probably the only one of its kind in India, the importance of this site in shaping purchase decisions is at par with that of the review sites. While performance is a good yardstick to choose a better product, the total user experience is also influenced by other aspects such as ease of availability, product ruggedness, prompt support and warranty issues. Such information can only be shared by Pros with the experience of buying and using the product.

While the site boasts of a healthy coverage of many products, it seriously lags when it comes to PC components. More Pros need to share their views on



Get the straight dope at Mouthshut.com